

Sexy Foods

Eat your way to better sex and better health. Here's a choice of high vitality, natural aphrodisiacs

Olive oil, almonds, avocados, hazelnuts:

Word has it that a diet rich in these will enhance potency, drive and fertility. Green olives make men more virile, while black ones increase women's sex drive.



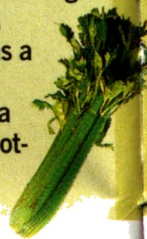
Banana: Can ignite passion in the bedroom. How? Contains the bromelain enzyme, which is believed to stimulate male libido. Rich in potassium and B vitamins (riboflavin) it's good for testosterone production.



Pumpkin, flax and sunflower seeds, cashew and pine nuts: They all have zinc, a key mineral necessary to maintain male potency. They also build sex hormones and are generally good for sexual wellness.



Celery: Excellent food to ramp up sexual stimulation. Contains androsterone, an odourless hormone released through male perspiration. Yuck? This one has a strange effect on women, same as a dozen roses & a bottle of champagne.



revolution and Viagra, falling libido is still a taboo subject. For Delhi-based IT professional, Jatin Rajpal, 30, all office systems are in compliance. But his personal system is just not working right. His wife is trying to conceive and he is under constant pressure to "deliver". He has lived under the shadow of his "failure to perform" for two years. "And it has affected more than just my sex life," he says, "The feeling that you are not like a real man depressed me so much that it affected my relationships and my job. I even contemplated suicide." Under the guidance of a doctor, he is now getting better acquainted with the term 'erectile dysfunction'. Unbeknownst to her live-in banker boyfriend, call centre employee Priya Rupani, 32, has been seeking counselling. Their five-year-old relationship has lost its spark. The couple have sex twice a month and generally it is organised and pre-planned "thereby killing any spontaneity", she rues. "We were good in bed. Now all both of us want to do is catch up on sleep or watch television," says Rupani. Her psychiatrist is advising her to work on her flagging libido.

Low libido is no longer an 'American affliction'. "High pay packages are coming with high stress levels," says Dr Rupin Shah, consultant andrologist and microsurgeon, Lilavati Hospital, Mumbai. "I see an increasing number of young couples, working for banks and MNCs, who have sexual problems arising from long work hours and high stress levels. They reach home too tired—mentally and physically—to have any intimacy, leave alone sex. Soon a pattern develops and sexual dysfunction sets in," he says. In the INDIA TODAY-AC Nielsen-ORG-MARG's sex survey conducted in 2006, nearly 42 per cent people said they had sex once or twice a month. Low frequency of intercourse indirectly leads to problems like erectile dysfunction and even perceived cases of infertility. Dr Firuza Parikh, Director, Department of Assisted Reproduction and Genetics, Jaslok Hospital and Research Centre finds it distressing that modern couples are deferring their sex drives in favour of careers: "Men are attaining job satisfaction at the risk of having low libidos, which in turn translates to involuntary infertility. Sex is no longer an activity of pleasure. I know of many couples who tell me that they

Male Menopause

A touchy subject. Men can have it all and at any age. That was the conventional wisdom. But mounting evidence suggests, the biological clock ticks for men, too. Technically, men do not have menopause. But they do go through a male equivalent called andropause, which is accompanied by symptoms similar in women.

Starting at the age of 30, the testosterone levels in men start declining by 1 per cent every year. Every man is affected differ-



have sex only on the right days for the sake of procreation."

But more often than not, falling erections, failing desire and even infertility arise from sexual myths, misconceptions and inadequate knowledge. Dr Uddhav Raj and Dr Piyush Goyal, gynaec laproscopists and hysteroscopists, say that infertility is on the rise and pick up of cases has doubled in the last five years. "Almost 12 to 15 per cent couples who come for infertility treatment are not actually infertile. In some cases, young couples don't know what normal intercourse is and haven't been able to consummate their marriage. A 24-year-old couple from an affluent business family came to us because they hadn't been able to consummate their marriage even after four months. In other cases, couples are unable to conceive only because they are not having sex at the right time," says Goyal.

Increasingly, gynaecologists and fertility experts are warning couples against deferring conception. "There is a huge gap between the beginning of sexual life and onset of reproductive life which exposes women to a number of infections. Maximum number of women who come to us are in the 27 to 34 age group," says Dr Raj. Other

42%

in India have sex
just once or
twice a month.